

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Digital Products is modelled as: A template, course, toolkit or data product.

Typical starting capital band: 0-2000. Expected time to first income or result: 14-90 days.

Risk: High. Complexity: Moderate. These are broad planning bands, not probabilities or guarantees.

WHO THIS IS FOR

Best suited to someone able to serve or access: People solving a repeatable problem.

Core capabilities: Research; Writing or production; Audience distribution.

Avoid or delay this route when essential bills, legal requirements, debt service, safety, liquidity or family commitments cannot be protected.

HOW MONEY IS GENERATED

A template, course, toolkit or data product

The paying counterparty or economic source is: People solving a repeatable problem.

Profit or retained value exists only after variable costs, fixed costs, tax, financing, returns, failures and owner labour are counted.

STARTING REQUIREMENTS

Capital: 0-2000.

Skills: Research; Writing or production; Audience distribution.

Tools: Problem interview script; Landing page; Content calendar; Conversion dashboard.

Verify registrations, licences, insurance, consumer rules, data protection, tax and sector-specific restrictions before trading or investing.

ILLUSTRATIVE UNIT ECONOMICS

Illustrative price or monthly value per unit: EUR 49.

Illustrative variable cost per unit: EUR 3.

Illustrative monthly fixed cost: EUR 250.

Illustrative monthly volume: 50.

Illustrative monthly revenue: EUR 2450; contribution before fixed costs: EUR 2300; operating surplus before tax and owner labour: EUR 2050.

Illustrative break-even volume: 6 units per month.

All figures are assumptions for planning. Replace them with verified local quotes and conservative scenarios.

FIRST 24 HOURS

Define one audience, one painful problem and one paid outcome.

Interview five potential users or inspect 30 real questions.

Draft a small paid product or service offer.

FIRST SEVEN DAYS

Publish a landing page and contact 50 relevant people.

Pre-sell or book a paid pilot.

Create only the minimum material required to deliver.

FIRST 30 DAYS

Reach ten paying customers or document why the offer failed.

Measure conversion and refund causes.

Create an email follow-up and referral path.

FIRST 90 DAYS

Build a product ladder or recurring offer.

Repurpose proven material into search, email and partnerships.

FIRST YEAR ROADMAP

Quarter 1: prove demand, suitability or operational feasibility with the smallest responsible test.

Quarter 2: improve unit economics, documentation, compliance and repeatability.

Quarter 3: reduce concentration, strengthen reserves and build a second acquisition or distribution route.

Quarter 4: complete a full profit, cash-flow, tax, risk and continuation review before scaling.

CUSTOMER OR CAPITAL ACQUISITION

Use search intent, communities, partnerships, email and direct outreach. Build an owned list rather than relying entirely on one platform.

Record outreach volume, response, conversion, acquisition cost, retention and cash collection. For investments, record contribution, fees, allocation and reason for ownership instead.

TOOLS AND TEMPLATES

Problem interview script
Landing page
Content calendar
Conversion dashboard
Budget and cash-flow tracker
Pricing or suitability calculator
Break-even or loss-capacity calculation
Weekly scorecard
Risk register
90-day action plan

FAILURE ANALYSIS

Risk: Creating before validating. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.
Risk: Generic content without a buyer. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.
Risk: Platform dependence. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.
Risk: No repeatable distribution. Mitigation: verify it in writing before committing more money.

DECISION TEST

START NOW only when the smallest safe test is affordable and lawful.
LEARN FIRST when the model is understood but the required skill, evidence or compliance is missing.
TEST CHEAPLY when demand or suitability is uncertain.
AVOID when loss could threaten housing, health, tax compliance or essential obligations.
SEEK PROFESSIONAL ADVICE for contracts, tax, regulated investments, property, borrowing, employment law or complex entities.

PRIMARY RESEARCH ROUTES

EU digital business rules:
<https://europa.eu/youreurope/business/running-business/digitalising/>
CNIL: <https://www.cnil.fr/>

EVIDENCE AND LEGAL BOUNDARY

This material is educational and based on public information. It is not personalised financial, investment, legal or tax advice.

Costs, taxes, laws, returns and risks vary by location and personal circumstances.

Verify current rules and consult an appropriately qualified professional before committing significant money or signing contracts.

No guaranteed returns, fake case studies, hidden ownership, tax evasion, borrowed-money speculation or unsupported income claims are permitted.